



Burkina Faso



Africa

Tour du Faso

Burkina Faso has played host to this 10-day bicycle race since 1987. Covering about 800 miles (1,300 km), it is the African stage of an international cycling competition.



- 📏 105,869 sq miles (274,200 sq km)
- 👤 20.8 million
- ★ Ouagadougou
- 🗣️ Mossi, other languages (+5)

Flat and surrounded by six countries, Burkina Faso is a **farming** nation. Its landscape is dominated by **savanna** and most people live on the central plateau. Its large, biannual **arts and crafts** fair attracts artists from many African countries.



Traditional architecture

Many villages in Burkina Faso feature traditional granaries. They are built on circular wooden bases and have straw-topped roofs.



Joseph Jenkins Roberts

Arriving in Liberia in 1829, this African American merchant became the country's first president in 1848.



Surfing

A growing community of surfers ride the waves off Robertsport, a coastal town considered among the best surf spots in Africa.



Woodland kingfisher

This species of kingfisher is recognized by its blue feathers, bright beak, and fast flight through the forests of Liberia.



- 📏 43,000 sq miles (111,369 sq km)
- 👤 5.1 million
- ★ Monrovia
- 🗣️ Kpelle, Vai, Bassa, other languages (+6)

Getting its name ("freedom") when it was **settled by African Americans** freed from slavery, Liberia has been **independent** since 1848. It elected the **first female president** in Africa, Ellen Johnson Sirleaf (2006–2017).